

“Our **resentment** will be **changed into silk.**”

POEM BY AN ANONYMOUS NORTH VIETNAMESE SEAMSTRESS, 1966

DOCTOR (1942–70)

DANG THUY TRAM

Born in Hue in 1942, Dang Thuy Tram volunteered for service in North Vietnam fresh out of medical school in 1966. For four years, she worked as a battlefield surgeon, providing care to communist combatants and civilians from a mobile clinic hidden in the jungle, until she was killed in 1970. Tram's diary, found by an American GI, was returned to her family in 2005 and published, to great acclaim.



» AFTER

After the war, most Vietnamese women returned to traditional roles in the domestic sphere.

HOPE FOR CHANGE

Many South Vietnamese women who had supported the regime in the South fled the country **by boat** after 1975. Those who remained have not had it easy. Some areas still have issues with women being kidnapped, forced into sex work, or sold as brides. Economic reforms have limited female-headed households' access to loans. The Vietnam Women's Union is currently working alone to push for increased **gender equality**.